# Digital Forensics Incident Report: High-Volume Data Exfiltration

Case Reference: IR-EXFIL-2026-9041 | Severity: HIGH | Host: DFS-CORE-02

## 1. Incident Synopsis & Forensic Timeline

Between 01:00 UTC and 04:30 UTC on October 14, 2026, network detection monitors flagged anomalous, sustained high-volume egress traffic originating from the internal file server DFS-CORE-02 (IP: 10.200.4.55). Detailed deep-packet inspection revealed that the host was communicating with external adversary infrastructure using encrypted DNS tunneling and unauthorized SFTP connections.

*Forensic Host Artifacts & Memory Inspection: Process spoolsv.exe was injected with malicious Cobalt Strike beacon shellcode. Adversaries dumped NTDS.dit password hashes using compromised Domain Administrator account 'svc-backup-admin'. Scheduled task 'SystemMaintenanceAudit' established persistence across reboots.*

Total volume exfiltrated: 14.8 Gigabytes compressed archive (.7z format) containing corporate financial models and customer records.

## 2. Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)

| Indicator Value | Type | Threat Context | Status |
|---|---|---|---|
| 192.0.2.144 | IPv4 | Adversary Staging Server IP | Malicious |
| exfil-drop-secure[.]example[.]com | Domain | Destination Drop Domain | Malicious |
| hxxps://exfil-drop-secure[.]example[.]com/incoming/stream.php | URL | Defanged C2 Listener URL | Malicious |
| 5d41402abc4b2a76b9719d911017c592 | MD5 | Cobalt Strike Stager Hash | Malicious |
| 9f86d081884c7d659a2feaa0c55ad015a3bf4f1b2b0b822cd15d6c15b0f00a08 | SHA256 | Injected Beacon Binary | Malicious |

### 3. MITRE ATT&CK; Tactics & Techniques

- **T1048.003 (Exfiltration Over Alternative Protocol)**: Exfiltration over encrypted DNS and SFTP.
- **T1071.004 (DNS Communication)**: C2 beaconing using DNS query encapsulation.
- **T1053.005 (Scheduled Task)**: Persistence created under SystemMaintenanceAudit.
- **T1003.003 (NTDS Dumping)**: Compromise of active directory database secrets.

## 4. Immediate Containment Actions Required

1. **Session Termination**: Terminate all outbound sessions destined for 192.0.2.144 and domain exfil-drop-secure[.]example[.]com.

2. **Network Isolation**: Disconnect DFS-CORE-02 from the corporate LAN and initiate volatile memory acquisition.

3. **Password Rotation**: Execute global password rotation for all service accounts with Domain Admin privileges.

4. **EDR Blocklist**: Submit SHA256 9f86d081884c7d659a2feaa0c55ad015a3bf4f1b2b0b822cd15d6c15b0f00a08 to endpoint blocklists.

*Triage Assessment: HIGH SEVERITY (Score: 8.8 / 10.0)*